

Army helicopter encounters cigar shaped UFO



Illustration by Michael Schratt and Tom Ruffin

Of the many UFO reports by highly experienced pilots, few are as well documented as the case which occurred on the night of October 18, 1973 near Mansfield Ohio. This significant CEII case involved a U.S. Army Reserve UH-1 helicopter, which had four crew-members aboard. The sky was clear, visibility extended to fifteen miles. During a return flight (around 10:55 PM) to Cleveland which originated from Columbus, Sgt. Robert J. Yanacsek alerted the other crew-members that a red light was rapidly approaching from the east (Lt. A.D. Jezzi was flying at the time of the incident). Its closure rate on the helicopter was estimated to be approximately 700 mph. Thinking the unknown light may be from a military jet, Captain Lawrence J. Coyne grabbed the controls and performed an evasive maneuver by reducing power, and putting the helicopter into a steep dive. Then, the unknown object stopped and hovered above the helicopter. It was described by the crew-members as looking like a cigar shaped craft (approximately fifty feet in length), with a dome on top. It had a gunmetal gray exterior appearance, with a steady red light on the front, and a white light on the back. The strange object made absolutely no noise.

Then a strange beam of green light could be seen originating from the bottom of the craft which illuminated the helicopter. Just minutes earlier, the helicopter was descending to an altitude of 1,700 feet. Now, as the strange craft departed to the west, the altimeter read 3,500 feet and CLIMBING at a rate of 1,000 feet per minute. Then, the crew felt a strange "bump", and leveled off at 3,800 feet which seemed to signify the end of the encounter. Attempts by the crew to establish radio contact with nearby Mansfield Airport failed for a period of ten minutes indicating the presents of an unusual electro-magnetic disturbance. Ground observers also witnessed the mid-air encounter making this case one of the most credible within the field of Ufology. Sources: NICAP, *Uninvited Guests* by Richard Hall, *Strange Skies* by Jerome Clark

Reservists Back Up Pilot

UFO Encounter Affirmed

CLEVELAND, Ohio (AP) Army Capt. Lawrence J. Coyne has given the Federal Aviation Administration information about the sighting of an unidentified flying object, which he says nearly collided with his helicopter near Mansfield last week.

Three reservists aboard the Huey helicopter confirmed to a reporter Coyne's account of the incident as "unlike anything produced on Earth."

Coyne, commander of the 316th Medivac unit based at Cleveland Hopkins International Airport, said the helicopter was flying at 2500 feet when the crew chief, Sgt./5 Robert J. Yanacsek, 23, reported a red light about five miles to the east.

He said the crew at first thought it was a radio beacon but Yanacsek yelled "the light is moving. It's coming at us. It's on a collision course."

Coyne, a veteran of 19 years of military flying, grabbed the controls from his copilot, Lt. Arriggo D. Jezzi, 26, of Sandusky.

"IT LOOKED like a fighter plane coming straight for us," Coyne said. "I took immediate evasive action. I cut the power and dropped into a shallow dive.

"We dropped to 2000 feet, and it was headed right for us. We braced for impact."

Coyne said when the helicopter reached 1500 feet, the approaching craft appeared to stop momentarily about 500 feet overhead and banked to one side.

"We never saw anything like it before," he said. **"It was unreal... a cigar-shaped craft with a glowing, steady red light on its leading edge. A hull was at the very top of it, and a green light emitted from the rear of the craft filled our cabin with a green glow. It was eerie."**

Coyne said the strange craft hovered over the helicopter only a few seconds. He said he glanced at the altimeter and noticed that the helicopter had risen to 3800 feet.

None of the crew members felt the gravitational pull normally felt when a helicopter rises, Coyne added.

"We felt a bounce, and then the other craft took off to the northeast," Coyne said. Seconds later, the craft disappeared.

The pilot said efforts were made to radio Mansfield Airport immediately, but the helicopter received no response. He said the unusual communications blackout lasted about 10 minutes, until radio contact was established with the Akron-Canton Airport.

COYNE SAID he could offer no rational explanation for the incident. Crew member S-Sgt. John M. Healey, who is a detective in the Cleveland police intelligence unit, also was mystified.

Based on the quick appearance and disappearance of the craft, the crew members estimated its speed at more than 600 mph. Coyne said a conventional aircraft flying that close to the helicopter would create a great deal of noise but said no noise was heard.

Copilot Jezzi confirmed Coyne's description of the mysterious craft. He said the entire sequence of

events lasted "maybe five or six seconds."

"It was strange," he said. "We're all grown men. We'd never seen anything like it."

He said the red and green lights were not in a normal configuration for aircraft, and he noted that the craft was flying about 50 knots-about twice the legal limit in the controlled air space at that level.

"There was no downward motion, he said. "It stayed on our level and it was really moving fast."

He said Coyne contacted flight officials in Cleveland after the helicopter landed. He said they also could offer no explanation for the craft.

The Weather

Mostly sunny and clear today through Tuesday. High both days in the 70s, low tonight in the low 50s.

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Go Dancing

When you need someone to watch the kids, find the babysitter you want in *Enquirer Classified*. "I got a babysitter the second day my ad ran in *The Enquirer*," said D. Brock. If you think the fox trot is a hunting exercise, you need us. Call 421-6300.

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No rational explanation!

Helicopter crew 'tangles' with UFO

CLEVELAND, Ohio (AP) — An Army captain and three Army reservists who tangled with an unidentified flying object say they are still puzzled by the mysterious craft that flew past their helicopter last week.

The foursome reported it to Federal Aviation Administration officials after they landed in Cleveland, although officials there also were mystified by the incident.

According to the helicopter crew, they sighted the red light near Mansfield. The helicopter was flying about 2,500 feet, and the crew at first thought the light was a radio tower.

Seconds later, Spec. 5 Robert J. Yanacek yelled to the others: "The light is moving! It's coming at us."

Capt. Lawrence J. Coyne, a veteran of 19 years in military flying, grabbed the controls and dropped the helicopter in a shallow dive.

When the UFO approached, Coyne said crew members saw a cigar-shaped object "unlike anything produced on earth."

"It was unreal...with a glowing, steady red light on its leading edge. A hull was at the very top of it, and a green light emitted from the rear of the craft filled our cabin with a green glow.

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Lt. Arrigo D. Jezzi of Sandusky, the copilot, was sitting on the opposite side of the helicopter and couldn't see the UFO approach. But he heard the oth-

ers describing it, and then he saw it pass slightly above the helicopter and move off quickly toward the northeast.

Crew members estimated that the object was moving at more than 600 miles per hour, basing their guess on the rapid appearance and disappearance of the craft.

Jezzi said that is about twice the legal speed limit in the controlled air space at that level.

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Coyne said the approaching craft appeared to stop momentarily about 500 feet overhead and banked to one side. He said he glanced at the altimeter and noticed that the helicopter had risen to 3,800 feet.

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Neither Coyne nor any other members of the crew were able to offer any rational explanation for the incident.

Helicopter Crew Estimates UFO's Speed At Plus 600 mph

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UFO's said seen in Ottawa County

PORT CLINTON — Ottawa countians are among the numerous Ohioans who say they have spotted unidentified flying objects.

Four such reports were made to the Ottawa County Sheriff's department over the weekend with two reported Saturday and two more on Sunday.

One of the residents described the vessel as being cigar shaped with blue and white lights shining from it. Another resident said three UFO's were cited hovering over a home while a third resident reported seeing seven such vessels playing tag.

The citings were made east and south of Port Clinton while two were seen on Lake Erie, northwest of the city.

What
in the world



Unidentified Object Shakes Veteran Pilot

CLEVELAND (UPI) —Army Reserve helicopter Pilot Capt. Lawrence Coyne doesn't believe in unidentified flying objects or any of that other "stuff." But after his experience two weeks ago he's not so sure.

Coyne, a member of the 316th Medical Detachment stationed

Skylab Crew Prepares For Long Flight

CAPE CANAVERAL (UPI)— With their launch date just one week away, America's third and final Skylab crew spent Saturday boning up on the hundreds of complex systems they will be called upon to operate in their eight room orbiting space station.

Astronauts Gerald P. Carr, Edward G. Gibson and William R. Pogue are scheduled to lift off at 11:40 a.m. EST Nov. 10 on a record 60-day flight that could be stretched further to 85 days, if all goes well.

The all-rookie crew is training at the Johnson Space Center

at Cleveland Hopkins Airport, was returning from Columbus at 11 p.m. Oct. 18 when the UFO made its appearance.

"It was shaped like an airfoil or a streamlined fat cigar," said Coyne. "There was a red light on the front. The leading edge glowed red a short distance back from the nose. There was a center dome. A green light at the rear reflected on the hull."

"I'm a military commander," said Coyne. "I don't believe in UFO's, little green spacemen and all that stuff. But I had to file an official report in detail to the Army on this thing."

Coyne said when he first spotted the UFO his helicopter was cruising at 2,500 feet and had set the controls for a 20-degree dive but the helicopter climbed to 3,500 instead of descending.

"I had made no attempt to pull up," he said. "There was no noise or turbulence either."

Coyne said his crew chief, Sgt. Robert Yanacsek, spotted a red light on the horizon as the UFO approached at a rate "in excess of 600 knots.

"It came from the horizon to our aircraft in about 10 seconds," Coyne said. "We were on a collision course."

Coyne said he put the helicopter into a dive and "at 1,700 feet I braced myself for the impact with the other craft" but there was no crash.

"We looked up and saw it stopped right over us," Coyne said. "It had a big, gray, metallic-looking hull about 60 feet long."

Coyne said as he and his crew members stared at the craft the helicopter began to climb without his guidance.

"I made no attempt to pull up," he said. "All controls were set for a 20 degree dive. Yet we had climbed from 1,700 to 3,500 feet with no power in a couple of seconds with no G-forces or other noticeable strains." He said the UFO then left the area.

Nitric Acid Threatens Boston Area

BOSTON (UPI) —A Pan